Franklin Magoba

Software engineer in Nairobi. Works remotely with US and European timezones.

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SUMMARY

Full-stack engineer with 7 years of production experience across web, mobile and backend. I build TypeScript and Python services, React and React Native apps, and the cloud setup that keeps them running. I've shipped clinic booking APIs, insurance platforms, bank-feed workers, transit integrations and mobile apps used every day, and I've led small teams from spec to release.

EXPERIENCE

Coding Evaluation Contractor, AfterQuery

Aug 2025 to Present

Part-time, remote

- Write Harbor coding tasks that AI agents must solve, in Python, TypeScript, Kotlin, Swift, Rust and C++, each with a reference solution.
- Package each task as a Docker sandbox with gold tests and oracle/nop checks, so a run only passes when the fix is real.
- Write tests for the edge cases agents tend to skip, then review the output for code quality, not just a green run.

Technical Project Manager, GitStart (YC S19)

Jan 2023 to Present

Remote

- Built most of the Optibus operator integrations and maintain all of them: about 19 Python modules on AWS Lambda for payroll exports, timetables, duty overviews and PDF or Excel reports.
- Do the SRE work on those integrations, with monitoring and alerting in CloudWatch and Grafana.
- Built Alaan's NestJS workers on AWS SQS that pull Codat and Xero bank feeds, with retries for when the upstream API flakes.
- Shipped DocSum contract-review APIs in FastAPI with pgvector search, and moved slow parse jobs onto RabbitMQ.
- Led Ready Travel delivery through early 2025, reviewing Spring Boot and React changes before each release.
- Agree API contracts and data models with the client before code gets written, and gave final merge sign-off on 200+ PRs.

Senior Software Engineer, GitStart (YC S19)

May 2021 to Jan 2023

Remote

- Took over as tech lead on Ready Travel in 2022, leading 4 engineers across Spring Boot, React and React Native.
- Built real-time React and Next.js screens for Sway on Hasura GraphQL, with Express services behind it.
- Built React Native and React screens for Theia Pay, its currency-transaction app, on a Node.js backend running on AWS Lambda.
- Did frontend and mobile work on Betashares Direct.
- Wrote NestJS services on PostgreSQL with Redis on hot reads, deployed to AWS ECS and Lambda.

Software Engineer and SRE, Bright Coders Factory

Mar 2022 to Aug 2023

Part-time contract, remote (Opole, Poland)

- Ran client services on Kubernetes and managed the infrastructure in Terraform.
- Set SLOs, SLIs and error budgets for the backend services on AWS, led the postmortems after incidents, and set up CloudWatch monitoring.
- Wrote Express APIs in TypeScript for enterprise clients.
- Ran A/B tests with Firebase Remote Config on MenoLife, a React Native menopause tracker.

Frontend Web Developer, Modern Mirror (US client)

2022 to 2023

Part-time, remote

- Frontend web work on a virtual fitting product for fashion brands.

Software Engineer, UAP Old Mutual Group

Mar 2021 to Oct 2021

Full-time, Nairobi

- Built Node.js services and Next.js screens on PostgreSQL for daily policy transactions, with GraphQL APIs, raw SQL and no ORM.
- Cached the heavy report reads in Redis and shipped claims APIs with status notifications.

Software Engineer, Kinetic Technology Limited
Sep 2020 to Mar 2021

Nairobi

- Built internal tools for KISM and LSK in React and Node.js, shipped with Docker.

Software Engineer, Startappz Limited
Jul 2020 to Sep 2020

Nairobi

- Built the AAR Insurance Kenya app in Flutter, with WebSockets for live updates on a Laravel and MySQL API.

Software Engineer, Medbook Limited Kenya
May 2019 to Jun 2020

Nairobi

- Built clinic scheduling APIs in Laravel with Angular screens, where a transaction stops 2 staff booking the same slot.

PROJECTS

Optibus operator integrations GitStart
Jul 2024 to now

Integrations for a public-transport planning platform: payroll exports, timetables, duty overviews and PDF or Excel reports for operators such as SPTrans in Sao Paulo, Xtrafik in Sweden, a Tuscany network and an Austrian operator.

Built most of them and maintain all of them, plus the SRE work with CloudWatch and Grafana.

Python, AWS Lambda, CloudWatch, Grafana, pytest

Alaan Pay GitStart
Since 2023

UAE corporate cards and spend management.

Backend: NestJS workers on AWS SQS that pull Codat and Xero bank feeds, with retries and Jest tests on the sync paths.

NestJS, TypeScript, AWS SQS, Sequelize, Jest

DocSum GitStart
Since 2023

AI contract review for in-house legal teams.

Contract-review APIs in FastAPI with pgvector search feeding OpenAI models (RAG), and slow parse jobs moved onto RabbitMQ.

FastAPI, PostgreSQL, pgvector, RabbitMQ, OpenAI

Sway GitStart
2021 to 2023

Nonpartisan civic voting-group app.

Real-time screens in React and Next.js on Hasura GraphQL, with Express services behind it.

React, Next.js, TypeScript, GraphQL, Hasura, Express

Theia GitStart
2021 to 2023

Fintech and AI stock research app. I worked on Theia Pay, its currency-transaction app.

React Native and React screens on a Node.js backend running on AWS Lambda.

React Native, React, Node.js, AWS Lambda

Betashares Direct GitStart

Australian investing app.

Frontend and mobile developer.

Frontend, Mobile

Productlane GitStart

Customer support and feedback portal built on Linear.

Web app work.

Web app

Ready Travel GitStart
2022 to early 2025

Travel product with a Java backend serving web and mobile apps.

Took over as tech lead in 2022, led 4 engineers and set the architecture, then led delivery through early 2025.

Java, Spring Boot, React, React Native

AfterQuery agent-eval tasks AfterQuery — Aug 2025 to now

Coding tasks that AI agents must solve, used to evaluate models.

Write each task with a reference solution and gold tests, package it as a Docker sandbox with oracle/nop checks, and review agent output.

Python, TypeScript, Kotlin, Swift, Rust, C++, Docker

NocoDB (open source) GitStart — 2023

Fixes and a feature in NocoDB, the open-source Airtable alternative.

Co-authored 4 merged PRs: comma-separated multi-email invites in the NestJS service, a collaborator access dropdown that went dead after search, missing account page translations, and a column list scrollbar.

Vue, TypeScript, NestJS

Crowd.dev (open source) GitStart — 2023

UI fixes in Crowd.dev, a community data platform that is now part of the Linux Foundation.

3 merged PRs: an organization joined date that read 53 years ago, an organization name that sat off-center when other fields were missing, and member photos that didn't fill their area.

Vue, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS

Pipedream (open source) GitStart — 2023

New integration actions for Pipedream's open-source component library.

Opened PRs for a Xero find-or-create contact action, Podio create-item and file upload actions, and Toggl client and project creation.

JavaScript, Node.js, REST APIs

MenoLife Bright Coders Factory — 2022 to 2023

Menopause symptom tracker.

React Native app with SwiftUI and Kotlin native modules, and Firebase Remote Config A/B tests before full rollout.

React Native, SwiftUI, Kotlin, Firebase

Modern Mirror US client — 2022 to 2023

Virtual fitting for fashion brands.

Part-time frontend web developer.

Frontend

UAP Old Mutual internal services UAP Old Mutual Group — Mar 2021 to Oct 2021

Internal services for an insurer's daily policy transactions.

Next.js screens and Node.js services on PostgreSQL, with GraphQL APIs, raw SQL, Redis on heavy report reads, and claims APIs with status notifications.

Node.js, Next.js, GraphQL, PostgreSQL, Redis

KISM and LSK internal tools Kinetic Technology — Sep 2020 to Mar 2021

Internal tools for the Kenya Institute of Supplies Management and LSK.

Built in React on a Node.js backend, shipped with Docker.

React, Node.js, Docker

AAR Insurance Kenya Startappz — Jul 2020 to Sep 2020

Insurance app: policies, claims and M-Pesa payments.

Built the Flutter app with WebSockets for live updates, on a Laravel and MySQL API.

Flutter, Dart, WebSockets, Laravel, MySQL

Medbook Medbook Limited Kenya — May 2019 to Jun 2020

Hospital and clinic software.

Clinic scheduling APIs where a transaction stops 2 staff booking the same slot, raw SQL on PostgreSQL and MySQL, and a Swift and SwiftUI app.

Swift, SwiftUI, Laravel, PostgreSQL, MySQL

Chota Personal

2021, rebuilt 2026

Truck booking. A Flutter customer app from 2021, and a 2026 rebuild as a demo on seeded data.

Built both. The rebuild's race test fires 25 bookings at once and never double-books any of 12 trucks.

Flutter, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker

Keyhold Personal

Local-first, encrypted memory vault that AI assistants read through an MCP server.

Wrote it in TypeScript on Node.js, with hybrid recall over local embeddings and an encrypted vector cache.

TypeScript, Node.js, MCP, Embeddings

Kotlin and KMP apps Personal

Personal Android and Kotlin Multiplatform apps.

Experiments with GPS, Bluetooth LE, NFC and UWB on device.

Kotlin, Kotlin Multiplatform, Jetpack Compose

SKILLS

Languages	TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Java, Kotlin, Swift, Dart, Go, PHP, SQL
Backend	Node.js, NestJS, Express, FastAPI, Spring Boot, Laravel, REST, GraphQL, Hasura, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS
Web & mobile	React, Next.js, Angular, React Native, Flutter
Data	PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, pgvector
Cloud & reliability	AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions, CloudWatch, Grafana, SLOs, Postmortems, OpenTelemetry (personal)
AI	Agent evaluation, RAG, OpenAI API, MCP

EDUCATION

- BSc Computer Science, Second Class Honours (Upper Division), Multimedia University of Kenya, 2015 to 2019